

Dear Family and Friends,

Merry Christmas! We hope this season finds you filled with joy, peace, and maybe just a little chocolate (we're big believers in festive snacks). 2024 has been a whirlwind of adventures, milestones, and moments that made us laugh until we cried—or just cried. Here's a peek at what's been going on:

Jesse officially retired his Deacons Quorum camping gear and stepped into a new role as the Primary Chorister at church. Now, instead of campouts, he's leading singing time with energy and props. The kids seem to tolerate him, and we're convinced he's secretly auditioning for *The Greatest Showman 2*. Jesse is still working as an ICU physician for Intermountain Healthcare but has started working more in telemedicine, loving the ability to put in lots of miles on the stationary bike while saving lives.

Rachel continues to share her love of music, singing in *The Lamb of God* and *Hopebox Choir*, and playing the violin in the Davis County Orchestra. Between all that, hiking, and keeping everyone alive and fed, she's basically a superhero. She still insists she's not, but the rest of us know better.

Brian had an epic year! He tore up mountain biking trails and qualified for state as a freshman, showing off his grit and determination. In October, he reached another big milestone—getting his learner's permit! So, if you're driving around and see a very cautious (and slightly nervous) driver with a proud parent in the passenger seat, wave hello—it might just be us! When not on his bike or behind the wheel, he's working at Lagoon and still cracking us up with his "Friends" inside jokes. Brian is also still playing the cello, adding beautiful music to our home.

Lily has had a transformative year: starting junior high, learning the flute, rocking braces, and even saying goodbye to her tonsils. Yet she still found time to shine in ballet, enchanting us all as a mouse in *The Nutcracker*. Watch out world, she's unstoppable!

Sarah is on a mission to singlehandedly keep the Tooth Fairy in business—she lost so many teeth this year that we're considering getting her a punch card. Between soccer, dancing, and devouring chapter books, she's keeping life as energetic as ever.

Isabelle has been dazzling us with her creativity and curiosity. She won a Reflections music composition contest and still loves digging into human anatomy and geology. This year, she also joined her sisters at the Clytie Adams School of Ballet and the "First Lost Tooth Club," and was over the moon about it!

Grace is living her best royal life, declaring herself "Gracie Goo" and rocking a *Frozen*-inspired crown like it's her birthright. Her favorite parts of the week are library story time

and playgroups. She loves to tag along with everyone wherever they go. Whether she's bossing us around or just being utterly adorable, she's a tiny queen, and we wouldn't have it any other way.

This year's travels have been unforgettable. From chasing solar eclipses in Nanoo to taking in the wonders of London, Paris, and the Grand Canyon, it's been a year full of memories we'll cherish forever (and a few "are we there yet?" moments).

Life is crazy, chaotic, and beautiful, and we wouldn't trade it for anything. We're so grateful for all of you—our family and friends—who make our lives brighter. If you ever find yourself in Northern Utah, please come by. Jesse might even lead you in a singing time special.

With love, Jesse, Rachel, Brian, Lily, Sarah, Isabelle, and Grace